

BT406_Research Methodology & Skills Enhancement

Assignment 2

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Referencing Tools and Citation Styles: APA vs MLA

I. Referencing Tools for In-text Citations and Bibliography

Several tools are available to help researchers manage references and create in-text citations and bibliographies. Here are some popular ones:

1. Mendeley:

- Free reference manager and academic social network
- Features: PDF organizer, citation generator, collaboration tools
- Supports multiple citation styles

2. Zotero:

- Open-source reference management software
- Features: Web browser integration, sync across devices, collaboration tools
- Supports over 9,000 citation styles

3. EndNote:

- Commercial reference management software
- Features: Advanced bibliography formatting, manuscript matcher, collaboration tools
- Integrates well with Microsoft Word

4. RefWorks:

- Web-based reference management tool

- Features: Easy import from databases, collaboration tools, citation generator
- Often provided by academic institutions

5. Citavi:

- Reference management and knowledge organization tool
- Features: Task planner, knowledge organizer, citation generator
- Particularly popular in German-speaking countries

6. BibTeX:

- Reference management tool popular among LaTeX users
- Features: Plain text format, customizable citation styles
- Requires more technical knowledge to use

7. Google Scholar:

- While not a full-fledged reference manager, it offers citation export in various formats
- Features: Easy access to academic literature, “Cite” button for quick reference generation

These tools generally offer features like:

- Storing and organizing references
- Generating in-text citations and bibliographies in various styles
- Collaboration with other researchers
- Integration with word processors and web browsers

II. APA vs MLA Format: Key Differences

APA (American Psychological Association) and **MLA (Modern Language Association)** are two of the most commonly used citation styles. Here are their main differences:

1. Fields of use:

- **APA:** Commonly used in social sciences, education, and some scientific fields
- **MLA:** Primarily used in humanities, especially language and literature

2. In-text citations:

- **APA:** (Author's Last Name, Year of Publication)

Example: (Smith, 2020)

- **MLA:** (Author's Last Name Page Number)

Example: (Smith 45)

3. Bibliography title:

- **APA:** "References"
- **MLA:** "Works Cited"

4. Author name format in bibliography:

- **APA:** Last Name, First Initial. Middle Initial.

Example: Smith, J. A.

- **MLA:** Last Name, First Name Middle Name

Example: Smith, John Adam

5. Date placement in bibliography:

- **APA:** (Year). Directly after the author's name
- **MLA:** Year comes at the end of the citation

6. Capitalization in titles:

- **APA:** Only capitalize the first word of the title and subtitle, and proper nouns
- **MLA:** Capitalize all major words in the title

7. DOI (Digital Object Identifier) and URL:

- APA: Includes DOI when available, otherwise URL
- MLA: Includes URL but omits <http://> or <https://>

8. Volume and issue numbers (for journals):

- APA: Volume(Issue)
- MLA: vol. number, no. number

Example of a book citation:

APA:

(Note :Hanging Indentation Towards Right is used for both styles APA as well as MLA now a days)

References

Fierer, N. (2017). Embracing the unknown: disentangling the complexities of the soil

microbiome. *Nature Reviews Microbiology*, 15(10), 579-590.

Jiang, G. L. (2013). Molecular markers and marker-assisted breeding in plants. *Plant breeding*

from laboratories to fields, 45-83.

Massart, S., Olmos, A., Jijakli, H., & Candresse, T. (2014). Current impact and future directions

of high throughput sequencing in plant virus diagnostics. *Virus Research*, 188, 90-96.

MLA :

Work Cited

Fierer, Noah. "Embracing the Unknown: Disentangling the Complexities of the Soil Microbiome."

Nature Reviews Microbiology, vol. 15, no. 10, 2017, pp. 579-590.

Jiang, Guo-Liang. "Molecular Markers and Marker-Assisted Breeding in Plants." *Plant Breeding from Laboratories to Fields*, 2013, pp. 45-83.

Massart, Sébastien, et al. "Current Impact and Future Directions of High Throughput Sequencing in Plant Virus Diagnostics." *Virus Research*, vol. 188, 2014, pp. 90-96.

These differences reflect the varying emphases and conventions of different academic disciplines. Always consult the most recent style guide or your institution's specific requirements, as citation styles can be updated periodically.